

And the membership of the dissenting group varies from reading to reading.¹ Still, with the above reservation, one may reasonably speak of up to 95% of the extant MSS belonging to the Majority textual tradition.

I see no way of accounting for a 95% (or 90%) domination unless that text goes back to the Autographs. Hort saw the problem and invented a revision. Sturz seems not to have seen the problem. He demonstrates that the “Byzantine text-type” is early and independent of the “Western” and “Alexandrian text-types”, and like von Soden, wishes to treat them as three equal witnesses.² But if the three “text-types” were equal, how could the so-called “Byzantine” ever gain a 90-95% preponderance?

The argument from statistical probability enters here with a vengeance. Not only do the extant MSS present us with one text form enjoying a 95% majority, but the remaining 5% do not represent a single competing text form. The minority MSS disagree as much (or more) among themselves as they do with the majority. For any two of them to agree so closely as do P⁷⁵ and B is an oddity. We are not judging, therefore, between two text forms, one representing 95% of the MSS and the other 5%. Rather, we have to judge between 95% and a fraction of 1% (comparing the Majority Text with the P⁷⁵, B text form for example). Or to take a specific case, in 1 Timothy 3:16 some 600 Greek MSS (besides the Lectionaries) read “God” while only nine read something else. Of those nine, three have private readings and six agree in reading “who”.³ So we have to judge

¹ I will of course be reminded that witnesses are to be weighed, not counted; for my discussion of that point please see the section “Should not witnesses be weighed, rather than counted?” in Chapter 6 of my *Identity IV*.

² Sturz, *Op. Cit.* A text produced by taking two ‘text-types’ against one would move the UBS text about 80% of the distance toward the Majority text.

³ The readings, with their supporting MSS, are as follows:

ο – D

ω – 061

οϛ Θεοϛ – one cursive, 256 (and one Lectionary)

οϛ – N, 33, 365, 442, 1175, 2127 (plus three Lectionaries)

Θεοϛ – A, C^{vid}, F/G^{vid}, K, L, P, Ψ, some 600 cursives (besides Lectionaries) (including four cursives that read ο Θεοϛ and one Lectionary that reads Θεοϛ).

It will be observed that my statement differs from that of the UBS text, for example. I offer the following explanation.

Young, Huish, Pearson, Fell, and Mill in the seventeenth century, Creyk, Bentley, Wotton, Wetstein, Bengel, Berriman, and Woide in the eighteenth, and Scrivener as late as 1881 all affirmed, upon careful inspection, that Codex A reads “God”. For a thorough discussion please see Burgon, who says concerning Woide, “The learned and conscientious editor of the Codex declares that so late as 1765 he had seen traces of the Θ which twenty years later (viz. in 1785) were visible to him no longer” (*The Revision Revised*, p.